

Build and optimize your process map

Step 1: Create an Initial Process Map

- **Pool:** *RSP Metal Creations*
- **Lane 1: Sales Team**
 - **Start Event:** *Order notification received via email*
 - **Task:** *Manually check inbox and print order*
 - **Task:** *Update internal tracking system manually*
 - **Task:** *Prepare and send manual email to customer (If Substrate is unavailable)*
- **Lane 2: Production Manager**
 - **Task:** *Review art and check substrate availability*
 - **Exclusive Gateway:** *Are substrates available?*
 - *Condition Yes: Mark as "Available"*
 - *Condition No: Mark as "Unavailable" and note restock date*
- **Lane 3: Production Staff**
 - **Task:** *Retrieve substrate and print artwork*
 - **Task:** *Perform quality control*
- **Lane 4: Shipping Department**

- **Task:** *Package artwork and create label manually*
- **Task:** *Log tracking number manually*
- **End Event:** *Order shipped and fulfilled*

Step 2: Analyze the Process

- ☐ **Manual Hand-offs and Physical Documents:** *Orders are printed and physically carried between departments (Sales to Production to Shipping), which increases the risk of loss and delays.*
- ☐ **Repetitive Manual Data Entry:** *Sales staff must manually update the tracking system at multiple stages (order status, substrate availability, and shipping info), leading to high error potential.*
- ☐ **Manual Stock Verification:** *Production Manager performs a manual check for substrate availability instead of using an automated inventory system.*
- ☐ **Inefficient Customer Communication:** *Notification emails regarding delays are written and sent manually, slowing down the fulfillment cycle.*
- ☐ **Lack of Real-time Visibility:** *Tracking numbers are logged in a manual shipping log first, creating a delay before the Sales Team can update the customer.*

Step 3: Optimize the Process

- **Pool:** RSP Metal Creations (Integrated S/4HANA System)
- **Lane 1: Sales Team**
 - **Start Event:** *Order received via Web Store (System automatically creates a sales order).*
 - **Task (Service Task - Automated):** *System checks substrate availability in real-time.*
 - **Exclusive Gateway:** *Is substrate in stock?.*

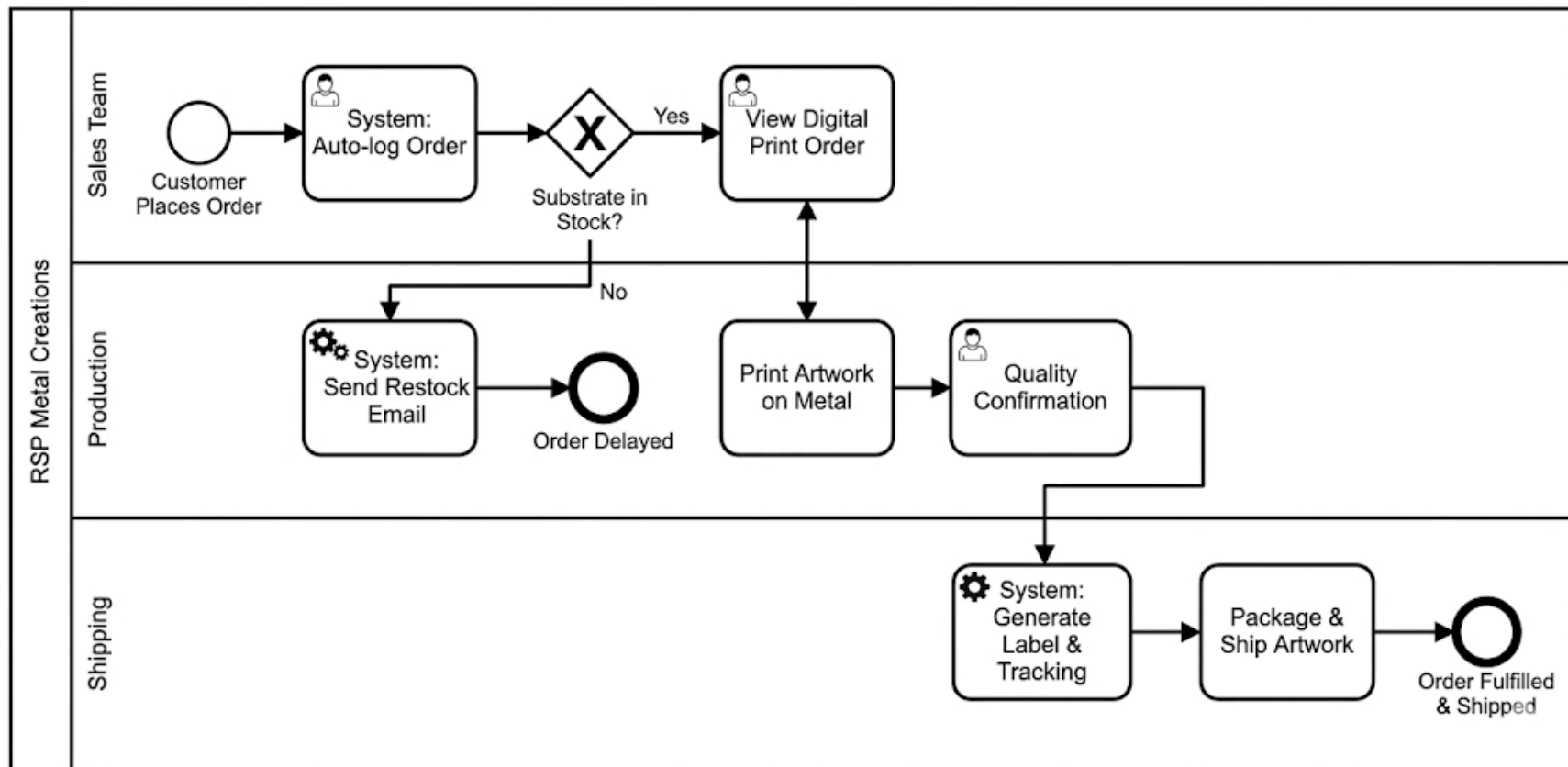
- **Condition No: Script Task (Automated):** System sends an automated "Delay Notification" email to the customer with the expected restock date.
 - **Condition Yes:** Process proceeds to Production.
- **Lane 2: Production Department**
 - **User Task (Fiori App):** Production Staff views the digital order on a tablet and confirms "Print Started".
 - **Task:** Print artwork on substrate.
 - **User Task:** Quality check confirmation in the system.
- **Lane 3: Shipping Department**
 - **Service Task (Automated):** System generates shipping label and tracking ID automatically upon production completion.
 - **Task:** Package and ship the artwork.
 - **End Event:** Order fulfilled (Customer automatically receives tracking link via system).

Step 3.1: Optimized "To-Be" Process Description

- **Pool:** RSP Metal Creations
- **Lane 1: Sales Team**
 - **Start Event:** Customer places order on website (System triggers process).
 - **Service Task:** Automated inventory check for metal substrates.
 - **Exclusive Gateway:** Are substrates available?
 - *If No:* **Script Task:** System sends automated restock notification to customer.
 - *If Yes:* Proceed to Production.
- **Lane 2: Production Team**
 - **User Task:** View digital order details via tablet/Fiori.

- **Task:** Print artwork on metal.
- **Lane 3: Shipping Department**
 - **Service Task:** System automatically generates shipping label and tracking ID.
 - **End Event:** Order shipped; customer receives automated tracking link.

Process – RSP Metal Creations (S/4HANA System)



Step 4: Document the Results

1. Overview of the "As-Is" Process

The initial process at RSP Metal Creations was characterized by manual intervention and physical hand-offs. It began with a manual email check by the Sales Team, followed by physically carrying printed orders to the Production Manager. The process relied on manual stock checks and manual updates to an internal tracking system. Key participants included the Sales Team, Production Manager, Production Staff, and the Shipping Department.

2. Identified Inefficiencies and Bottlenecks

Based on the analysis in Step 2, several critical issues were identified:

- **Manual Document Handling:** *Physically carrying printed orders between departments is time-consuming and risks data loss.*
- **Repetitive Data Entry:** *Sales staff must manually update order statuses at multiple points, leading to a high risk of human error.*
- **Manual Stock Verification:** *The Production Manager performs physical inventory checks, creating a significant bottleneck in the workflow.*
- **Disconnected Communication:** *Customer delay notifications are written and sent manually, slowing down the fulfillment cycle and reducing professional consistency.*

3. Rationale for "To-Be" Optimizations

The "To-Be" process utilizes SAP S/4HANA capabilities and BPMN 2.0 best practices to streamline operations:

- **Automated Inventory Check (Service Task):** *By automating the substrate check, we eliminate the Production Manager's manual task, reducing processing time.*
- **System-Triggered Notifications (Script Task):** *Automated emails for delayed orders ensure immediate customer communication and reduce the Sales Team's workload.*

- **Digital Order Routing:** Replacing physical prints with digital Fiori app notifications ensures real-time data visibility and zero risk of lost paperwork.
- **Automated Label Generation:** Shipping labels and tracking IDs are now generated automatically by the system, ensuring data accuracy and faster shipping.

4. Summary of Improvements and Future Enhancements

The optimized process significantly reduces manual labor, minimizes the risk of errors through automation, and improves the overall customer experience with faster notifications.

Future Enhancements could include:

- **Predictive Analytics:** Implementing SAP AI to predict substrate shortages before they occur.
- **Customer Portal:** A self-service portal where customers can track their metal artwork in real-time without Sales Team intervention.